

V. Manickavasagam
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India's doctoral research ecosystem in Social Sciences is in urgent need of a structural overhaul. While doctoral scholars in other countries are evaluated on working prototypes and real-world applications, the Indian system remains wedded to voluminous dissertations and the pressure to publish in so-called peer-reviewed or indexed journals.

Problems
The mandatory publication requirement has lowered the quality of research and spawned an entire ecosystem of predatory and cloned journals that exploit desperate doctoral candidates who pay hefty sums to get their papers published. The publishing landscape has undergone a damaging inversion: where journals once paid scholars for their contributions, today scholars pay for the privilege of being published. Even more troubling is the exploitation by supervisors, ranging from demands to ghostwrite papers under the supervisor's name to performing domestic errands and, in extreme cases, being asked to pay to complete research within stipulated deadlines.

Universities themselves are not free of blame. Administrative delays plague doctoral candidates from the moment of registration up to thesis adjudication and result publication. In one reported incident, a Teacher Association had to intervene just to clear procedural formalities and resolve the reasons behind a delay.
The contrast with the Sciences is stark. Doctoral stu-

dents collaborate on lab experiments, co-develop working protocols, create patentable products, and contribute to joint intellectual property. Social Science scholars, meanwhile, work in relative isolation on topics chosen less for societal relevance than for administrative compliance, completing research that is rarely tested

against real-world rigour.

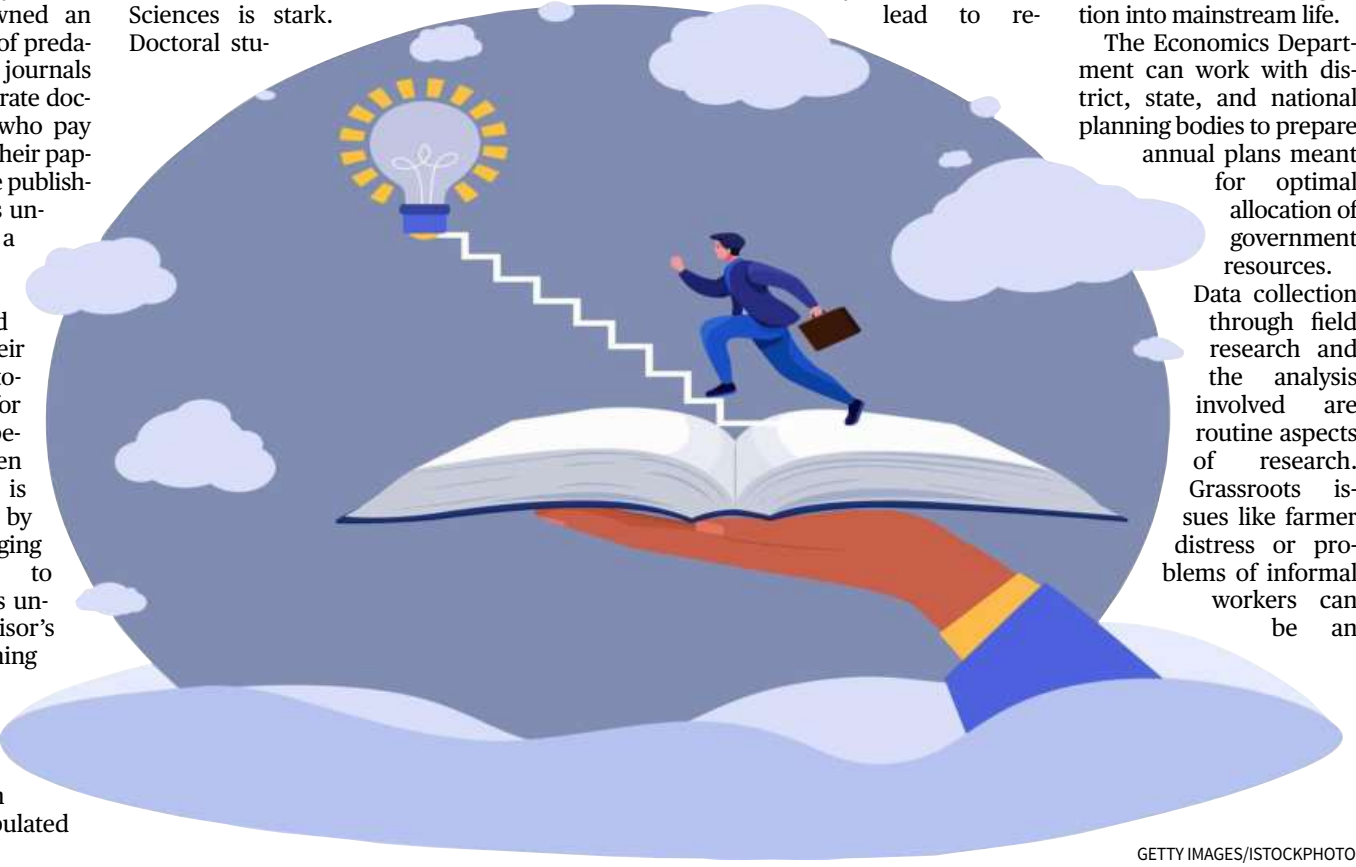
Revamp needed
A resurgence in the research environment in Social Science requires regulatory bodies to ensure that universities are linked with the society around them. A mandatory academia-industry link for research and adoption of higher education institutes by industries can lead to re-

search projects that address the problems that these companies face.
The departments of Pedagogy, Adult Education, and Lifelong Learning can be directed to focus on issues such as curriculum design challenges, the integration of Artificial Intelligence in teaching and learning, and the development of scientific student assessment tools. By maintaining direct links with government departments and organisations working with child welfare, the Departments of Special Education and Rehabilitation can look at early identification of differently-abled children and their integration into mainstream life.
The Economics Department can work with district, state, and national planning bodies to prepare annual plans meant for optimal allocation of government resources. Data collection through field research and the analysis involved are routine aspects of research. Grassroots issues like farmer distress or problems of informal workers can be an

area of collaborative research with Labour Commissions, State Finance Commissions and so on. So far, only a handful of institutions such as Gokhale Research Institute and the Madras Institute of Development Studies have made a mark in the national planning bodies. Creating a link with governmental organs can help Economics departments transform shelf-bound research into a mutually beneficial societal endeavour. Departments of Sociology, Social Work, Psychology and Philosophy can establish links to local bodies, prisons, juvenile homes and NGOs working in rehabilitation and child protection to address and find solutions to social problems.
The doctoral theses that result from India's current research system often lie in university archives; unread, unapplied, and of no use to the stakeholders in whose name they were ostensibly written. This is a systemic failure of purpose. The missing link between academia and society must be not only established but made mandatory in every university. Only then will India's doctoral degrees reflect the rigour and relevance that the nation's investment in higher education demands.

Views expressed are personal

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SCHOLARSHIPS

Raman Kant Munjal Scholarships
An initiative by the Raman Kant Munjal Foundation, supported by Hero FinCorp.
Eligibility: Indian nationals in the first year of BBA, BFIA, B.Com. (H, E), BMS, IPM, B.A. (Economics), BBS, or any other Finance-related degree who have secured at least 80% in classes 10 and 12 (70% for students in the PwD category) and have an annual family income not exceeding ₹600,000.
Rewards: Ranging from ₹40,000 to ₹550,000 a year for three years.
Application: Online
Deadline: August 31
www.b4s.in/edge/IKMSP6

ICPC Internship
Offered by the Policy, Politics and Governance Foundation.
Eligibility: Students in the

final or penultimate year of graduation and interested in a career in political or policy strategy consultation.
Rewards: ₹5,000 a month and certificate
Application: Online
Deadline: Round the year
www.b4s.in/edge/ICPII

Jawaharlal Nehru Memorial Fund Scholarship for Doctoral Studies
Offered by the Jawaharlal Nehru Memorial Fund.
Eligibility: Full-time Ph.D. scholars below 35 years as of October 1 registered to a recognised Indian institution and have a first-class postgraduate degree with at least 60% aggregate.
Rewards: Up to ₹18,000 a month and benefits.
Application: Offline
Deadline: August 31
www.b4s.in/edge/JNMF3

Courtesy: Buddy4study.com

IELTS update

IDP Education has announced that IELTS in India will transition from IELTS on Paper to IELTS on Computer from September 2026. The IELTS on Paper will be available in India until August end.
From September 2026 onwards, candidates in India will be able to choose from two options. IELTS on Computer will have the Listening, Reading

and Writing sections on a computer. IELTS on Computer (Writing on Paper) allows test takers to complete the Listening and Reading sections on a computer, while completing the Writing section on paper.
The Speaking test will continue to be conducted face-to-face with a certified IELTS examiner for both modes. For more information on the changes, visit ieltsdipindia.com/

Don't lose your way!

Uncertain about your career options? Low on self-confidence? This column may help



OFF THE EDGE
Nandini Raman

I finished B.Sc. Psychology and enrolled in civil services coaching but could not continue due to health issues. Should I do a Master's and prepare alongside? Can I get a job at this stage? Rishab

Dear Rishab,
Psychology is one of the most applicable undergraduate qualifications in today's job market because people who understand human behaviour are valued across industries.
What do you want to do? Do you feel ready for work? Or do you want to study further while attempting the UPSC again?
Pursuing a Master's (M.A. or M.Sc.) while preparing for the Civil Services provides a routine, a peer group and a strong 'Plan B', while reducing the pressure of relying solely on the unpredictable UPSC exam. You can also choose Psychology as your Optional Subject in the Mains.
But returning to full-time coaching is advisable only if your health is all right and you have the stamina for long study hours. The stress of the exam cycle can trigger a relapse.
If you wish to work, consider roles such as HR Coordinator, Content Writer or Behavioural Copywriter, or Mental Health Content Coordinator in corporate or wellness firms or start-ups. Please note, however, that you cannot practise as a licensed therapist or clinical counsellor in India without a

Master's degree (M.A./M.Sc.).

My son is in Class 9 (IGCSE). Can he write the NDA exam after Class 12? If he wants to study abroad, will he need to take English language tests? Satish

Dear Satish,
He can write the NDA exam during or after Class 12/A Levels. For the Army, he can complete Class 12/A Levels in any stream.
However, for the Air Force or Navy, Physics and Maths are required as core subjects in Class 12.
However, the UPSC, which conducts the NDA, requires official verification of foreign qualifications, so an Equivalence Certificate from the Association of Indian Universities (AIU), New Delhi, certifying that his Cambridge A-Level results are equivalent to an Indian CBSE Class 12 certificate is necessary. This is a fairly straightforward online application process which can be done once his A-Level results are out.
Regarding exams like IELTS or TOEFL to study abroad, he is likely to qualify for a waiver but, to maximise his chances, he should choose English as a First Language in IGCSE instead of English as a Second Language, as most countries waive the English language requirement if he scores Grade C (Grade 4/5) in English as First Language.

I did Science with Biology and plan to take the CUET in 2027. I want to choose Humanities as my domain subjects and pursue a degree in IR while receiving coaching for the UPSC exams. I aspire to become an Indian ambassador. Is this

correct? Nasrin

Dear Nasrin,
As per NTA and DU guidelines, you can take CUET domain subjects only in the subjects you studied in Class 12. Since you did Science stream, you will have to choose only those subjects in the CUET. Opting for Humanities subjects without having studied them in school can lead to disqualification during admissions. But, based on your CUET scores, you can still apply for B.A. (Hons) Political Science.
Since UG degrees in International Relations are limited, a B.A. (Hons) Political Science provides a strong foundation in global politics, foreign policy, Indian polity and constitutional law. Aim for leading institutions where you'll also benefit from exposure to embassies, think tanks and civil services preparation.
To become an Ambassador, you must clear the UPSC Civil Services Examination with a high rank and qualify for the IFS. Start reading a national newspaper regularly, focusing on world affairs and explanatory articles. In college, participate in Model United Nations (MUNs), debates, and international forums to build your knowledge and communication skills.

I want to to prepare for SSC-CGL. People around me are not aware of this exam so I don't have proper guidance. How can I crack the exam? Sandra

Dear Sandra,
The Staff Selection Commission Combined Graduate Level (SSC-CGL) exam recruits candidates for

prestigious Group B and C posts such as Income Tax Inspector, Central Excise Inspector or Assistant Section Officer. The selection process has two computer-based stages, and your Tier 2 score determines the final merit and job allotment.
Tier 1 is a qualifying exam with 100 questions (200 marks) to be completed in one hour, with sectional timing and 0.5 marks deducted for every wrong answer. You get 15 minutes per section.
Tier 2 includes Mathematical Abilities (30 questions), Reasoning (30), English Language (45), and General Awareness (25). It also has a Computer Knowledge Test (20 questions) and a Data Entry Speed Test, both of which are qualifying in nature. There is a one-mark penalty for every incorrect answer. For Quantitative Aptitude, use *Play with Advanced Maths* (Abhinav Sharma) or *Quantitative Aptitude* (Rakesh Yadav). For English, study *Plinth to Paramount* (Neetu Singh) and *Black Book of English Vocabulary* (Nikhil Gupta). For Reasoning, practise with Kiran Publications' Chapter-wise Previous Year Questions (PYQs). For General Awareness, use Lucent's *General Knowledge* and the Pinnacle MCQ Book. Focus on current affairs over the last 10 months with special attention to topics like Indian Constitution, History and Science. Finally, practise past papers of the last five years. SSC often repeats question patterns, so this is one of the most effective preparation tools.
Disclaimer: This column is merely a guiding voice and provides advice and suggestions on education and careers.
The writer is a practising counsellor and a trainer. Send your questions to eduplus.thehindu@gmail.com with the subject line Off the Edge

Ready for more?

Why universities must move beyond 'job readiness' and embrace the more durable concept of 'future readiness'

Attila Brungs

In an era defined by rapid technological disruption and shifting career pathways, the question – are graduates truly 'job ready'? – has become more urgent and complex than ever before. As careers increasingly span industries, geographies and skill sets, traditional definitions of readiness are being fundamentally challenged.
'Job readiness' is a phrase frequently directed at university leaders by government, advocacy groups and business communities demanding that students graduate ready to step seamlessly into the workforce. However, as traditionally applied to universities, this is an outdated phrase rooted in an earlier industrial model; one that assumes university education can be reduced to a brief moment in time between high school and employment where individuals gain a credential, then 'set and forget' as they embark on their careers.

Such an assumption may have worked when the pace of technological change was slow enough to allow the vocational specifics of a degree to remain relevant across a person's entire career. Today, we are living through the most profound societal disruption since the Industrial Revolution.

Just five years ago, generative AI was barely part of mainstream discourse. Over the course of a single degree, the way in which people learn has been radically transformed. The technical particulars that people acquire in disciplines such as Computer Science and Medicine are



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now often obsolete within a few years of graduation.
Creating future-ready graduates is no longer as simple as equipping them with a fixed set of skills and sending them into the workforce. It is about recognising that the true value of a university education lies in building foundational capabilities such as critical thinking, creativity, and complex problem-solving that make graduates adaptable and less vulnerable to redundancy.
These capabilities cannot be developed in isolation. Once established, universities must then ensure they give students meaningful opportunities to apply these skills in real workplaces before graduation. It is in the practice of using knowledge in the world and reflecting on what works, what does not (and why) that graduates develop the habits of mind needed for a lifetime of reinvention.

Eye on the future

Leading universities across the world are now increasingly embedding work-integrated learning across disciplines or 'outcome-based learning', ensuring students engage with real-world challenges before graduation and learn not

only to identify problems, but to understand their own decision-making so they develop the capacity to transfer skills across contexts.
We must therefore move the focus beyond 'job readiness' and instead embrace the more durable concept of 'future readiness'. Future readiness recognises the breakneck speed of societal change. The future of global graduate employability will be defined by a graduate's ability to think critically, solve complex problems, collaborate effectively and apply interdisciplinary knowledge to real-world challenges. It will crucially depend on their ability to work across cultures and geographies, to navigate ethical and regulatory landscapes, to build productive relationships with people, to communicate clearly to technical and non-technical audiences, and, perhaps most importantly, to adapt to roles that may not yet exist.

Steps

As well as ensuring these foundational capabilities are developed, there are other measures universities can take to ensure future-ready graduates. First is to resist the tendency to pitch disciplines against

one another. Science vs the Arts. Qualitative vs Quantitative. These are false binaries that fundamentally misunderstand the workforce challenges of the coming decades: productivity, social cohesion, decarbonisation, cybersecurity, global health, resilient supply chains and sovereign capability. These challenges do not sit neatly within one subject matter. The graduates who will have the greatest impact will combine technical capability with policy awareness, social insight, commercial awareness and ethical reasoning.
Second is to reimagine higher education as a life-long partnership. Engagement with universities must no longer be seen as a one-time experience. Careers will increasingly involve re-skilling and up-skilling at multiple points. Universities must support graduates beyond their initial degree, whether this be through doctorates, Master's programmes, micro-credentials, stackable programmes or flexible postgraduate pathways that align with evolving industry needs.
Third, universities must ensure that graduates are culturally literate and globally aware. Exposure to cross-cultural learning environments can play a critical role in preparing graduates for global careers. In countries like India, for example, where diversity spans language, region and socio-economic contexts, this becomes even more critical.
We should stop asking whether graduates are ready for work. The more important question is whether they are equipped to remain relevant as work itself continues to change. If universities fail to make that shift, it is not students who will fall behind, but the institutions themselves.

The writer is Vice Chancellor and President at the University of New South Wales (UNSW), Australia.



WIDE ANGLE
Albert P' Rayan

The National Education Policy 2020 (NEP) celebrates “critical thinking” and emphasises its importance. The term appears 47 times in the policy document, underscoring the significance of higher-order cognitive abilities, problem-solving, and learner-centred education. But were those who drafted the policy and those currently in power aware that students who become genuine critical thinkers might question everything, raise their voices against systems that hinder reform, and demand accountability from those in authority? Probably not.

Students protest

That is precisely what is happening in the country today. Several young people have gone on hunger strike, while hundreds of students have joined protests demanding the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra



EMANUAL YOGINI

Beyond the syllabus

What happens when students start thinking?

Pradhan, in the wake of the NEET-UG paper leak, as well as several other irregularities in the education system. By questioning the system and demanding reform, these youngsters are demonstrating the critical-thinking skills that the NEP seeks to promote.

Their anger is real, their reasoning is compelling, and their demands for accountability and reform are genuine.

At the time of writing, thousands of young people and students from across the country had joined protest marches that continued to draw large crowds.

The more the government attempts to suppress the voices of protesters, the louder they seem to become.

Yet the government that champions the NEP and seeks to impose it on every state appears to be responding to dissent not through dialogue but

through repression. Apolitical educator and climate activist Sonam Wangchuk recently ended his 26-day hunger strike, but the government remained unmoved and refused to engage with him until his deteriorating health made inaction impossible.

Equally disturbing was

the silence within academia. Many academics appeared reluctant to publicly express solidarity with the activist or demand education reforms. If education does not nurture courage, empathy, and a sense of justice, what is its purpose? More importantly, what kind of education are we imparting to our students?

What makes some students join such non-political protests while others choose not to participate? Is it something to do with their education? Should true education do more than impart knowledge and skills? Should it also foster awareness, critical thinking and civic engagement?

We need an education that liberates people from all forms of bondage. However, those who seek to control the masses may not favour an education that encourages independent thinking, critical inquiry, and awareness of injustice.

An educated and empowered population is more likely to question authority, challenge oppression, and demand accountability. Education can become a powerful instrument of

liberation, but only when it enables people to think for themselves rather than merely accept what they are told.

Beyond jobs

Today, policymakers, teachers, parents and students often hold a narrow view of education. They believe that its primary goal is to prepare students for successful careers and financial prosperity. Education that seeks to develop socially responsible human beings capable of contributing to a more just society is often dismissed as outdated or undesirable.

Education for liberation, however, is a holistic approach to learning that nurtures equality, fairness, inclusiveness and respect for human rights. It prepares students to become responsible citizens who respect diversity, appreciate different perspectives, promote social justice, think critically about issues, and make informed decisions.

When those who fight for their rights through democratic means are labelled anarchists, and those who fight for justice are branded terrorists, the

true purpose of education is not merely undermined; it is killed and buried. In such a situation, “educated” people have a moral responsibility to express solidarity with those who fight for educational reform and to help resurrect the true purpose and glory of education.

So, how can education help us now? Let us examine the issue critically. Let us ask whether the protesters are fighting for a just cause and why the government remains insensitive to their demands. Above all, let us ask ourselves: Does our education liberate us from the shackles of narrow-mindedness and political affiliation and make us more empathetic and committed to justice? If the answer is ‘yes’, we have become genuine critical thinkers – and our critical thinking can lead us to action. Now that the government has realised the power of critical thinking in action, will it delete the sections detailing the importance of this vital 21st-century skill?

Views are personal

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GREEN CAREERS HUB

Every drop counts

‘Zenrainman’ S. Vishwanath on planning for a water-secure future

The next in the monthly series by WWF-India that highlights niche and unconventional green careers through the stories of well-known personalities from the field of environment and conservation

Nearly 30 years ago, I received an unexpected phone call late one night. It was Venamma, a woman from the drought-prone village of Kuruburakunte. It had finally rained after months and the 4,000-litre rooftop rainwater harvesting tank we had helped design for her home was overflowing. Through happy tears, she said we should have built a bigger tank. For her, that overflowing tank meant she no longer had to walk two kilometres every day to fetch water.

Moments like that have defined my career in water management. My work focuses on helping communities improve water security through practical solutions such as rainwater harvesting, restoring lakes and village tanks, groundwater recharge, and better planning of water resources. Every project is different, but the goal is the same: ensuring that people have reliable access to water while protecting the environment for the future.

Beginnings

My journey began with a degree in Civil Engineering, where I developed a foundation in Hydrology, Geology and Soil Science. Wanting to understand how water shapes the development of entire towns and regions, I went on to pursue a PG Diploma in Urban and Regional Planning. Together, these disciplines helped me understand both the science of water and the larger systems that influence how it is managed.

One of my earliest roles was with the Housing and Urban Development Corporation (HUDCO). During the late 1980s and early 1990s, I travelled extensively across small and medium towns and remote villages



to visit housing projects and saw houses standing ready for families to move into. But unreliable water supply and poor sanitation prevented people from living in them comfortably. It became increasingly clear that development could not succeed unless these basic needs were addressed.

Later, I joined Arghyam, a philanthropic organisation that supports partners working on water-related challenges across India. There, I learned another important lesson: listening to local knowledge, understanding the landscape and working alongside people who live with these challenges every day often leads to better outcomes than relying on technical expertise alone.

A typical day may involve discussing projects with colleagues, visiting communities to understand the challenges they face, speaking with well diggers, or interacting with government departments where I serve as a technical expert.

People centric

Over the years, I have realised that deep listening is, perhaps, the most valuable skill in this profession. Technical knowledge is essential, but it is only one part of the solution. Good water management also requires empathy, collaboration, and understanding what is practical for the people who will ultimately use these solutions. For me, successful projects are those that promote social justice, improve the environment and are techni-

cally sound, in that order.

Another unforgettable moment came from the village of Picchaguntlahalli, where a desilted village tank once again began storing rainwater. A farmer proudly handed me a 50 kg bag of rice and said it was the first time they had harvested three crops in a year because water was finally available. These experiences stay with me far longer than reports or project documents!

The challenges in this field are rarely straightforward. Water issues are often rooted in decades of history, and resources are almost always limited. Finding practical, affordable solutions requires patience, teamwork and constant learning. I have also been fortunate to draw inspiration from countless people along the way, especially those working on the frontlines in difficult circumstances with remarkable resilience and commitment.

For students exploring career options, I believe this is an exciting time to work in water management. Climate change is making water security one of the defining challenges of our generation. Future solutions will combine field experience with emerging technologies such as AI, but curiosity, empathy and a willingness to listen will remain just as important. Find a good mentor, spend time in the field and keep learning. You may discover, as I did, that helping communities solve water challenges is a career that grows with you for life.

Anand Narasimha

Walk into any campus placement season and the same story will be playing out. Companies looking for people who can handle brand roles meet smart, hard-working graduates who have studied marketing, done their internships, and built decent resumes. They leave, more often than not, underwhelmed. The graduates can run a campaign and manage a content calendar. What they find hard to do is think about a brand: its meaning, its position and its long-term direction. That ability – the core of brand management – is simply not what most programmes are built to develop.

Indian management education was designed around a generalist philosophy that worked for much of its history. Marketing was a broad function and a broad education made reasonable sense. Over time, brand management grew into something with its own depth and demands. It draws on consumer psychology, business strategy, cultural understanding, creative thinking, and financial judgment, often all at once. But the curriculum has not moved with it.

Chitranshu Mahant

Artificial Intelligence has become a part of everyday student life. Many young people already use AI tools while searching online, summarising notes, writing emails or preparing assignments. Using AI no longer feels experimental; it has become part of how everyday digital work gets done. Alongside these tools, another form of AI is beginning to appear more often in digital experiences: Agentic AI.

Most AI systems today respond to one instruction at a time. A user asks something, receives a response and then gives another prompt to continue the task. Agentic AI is designed differently. Instead of handling only one step, it tries to understand the larger goal behind the request and help complete different parts of the process together.

For example, a student preparing for a college seminar may need to collect information, organise notes, prepare questions and structure talking points. Earlier, these steps were usually handled separately across different platforms and applications.



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The brand gap

Why Brand Management requires a separate programme

No real immersion

In most programmes, brand management occupies a few weeks within a marketing specialisation. Students encounter frameworks and case studies, get a working familiarity with the language of brands, and move on. What they do not get is real immersion, the kind that builds actual judgment. By graduation, most students have attended lectures, read cases, and ticked the boxes. But they have never really sat with a brand problem long enough to develop an opinion. What this produces, at scale, is a

market flooded with people who are good at execution and thin on strategic brand thinking.

Digital and social media created an entire ecosystem of marketing work built around doing. Managing platforms, producing content, running performance campaigns, tracking metrics ... these became the daily reality of early-career marketing jobs and education responded accordingly. Programmes loaded up on tools, platforms, and techniques. Graduates became highly competent operators.



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Beyond the prompt

What students need to know about Agentic AI

Systems using Agentic AI can help connect parts of this workflow more smoothly. The purpose is not to replace the user, but to reduce the amount of repetitive digital work involved in completing everyday tasks.

Why it is important

Students today spend time working across digital systems. Research, assignments, presentations, applications, communication, and learning resources are often spread across multiple tabs and platforms. Managing all can become exhausting. Also, they are no longer struggling to access information but to manage the volume of it. Instead of

constantly organising information and moving between applications, they can focus more on understanding the task itself.

The use of these systems is also expanding beyond academics. A student applying for internships, for instance, may need to draft emails, compare opportunities, prepare resumes and organise interview notes. For first-time users especially, the challenge is often not the task itself, but figuring out how to manage everything around it.

Pause and reflect

At the same time, students also need to understand the limitations of these systems. AI-generated responses are not always ac-

What to teach

That deserves more than a semester of electives. A brand programme worth its name does not borrow legitimacy from a marketing course. It stands on its own and starts with the basics. Why do people choose the brands they do? How do culture, context, and psychology drive those decisions? How does a call made about a brand today show up in the numbers a year or three down the line? It means teaching students to build strategy from genuine human insight rather than surface-level data. It means making

the financial logic of brand investment legible, so that brand managers can hold their ground in a room full of spreadsheets. It means using analytics and technology as aids to sharper thinking, not as replacements for it. It means building all of this through practice: through live brand problems, real diagnoses, and recommendations that get stress-tested by people who have actually done the work.

The brand manager today has to bring together the instincts of a psychologist, the discipline of a strategist, the sensibility of a storyteller, and the grounding of a business manager. That profile does not emerge from a generalist programme with a few brand electives. Specialist business education has been growing steadily in other parts of the world. India is beginning to follow. The appetite is there, from students who want deeper expertise and from companies that want people they can actually trust with their brands. The classroom needs to close that gap urgently. India's brands are more ambitious than ever. The people building them should be too.

The writer is Dean and Professor, The Specialist Brand School

ers often share personal information online without fully understanding how that data may later be used or stored.

Responsible use

As these systems become more common, responsible usage becomes equally important. Students should treat AI as a support tool rather than a replacement for effort. Asking thoughtful questions, verifying information, and understanding how conclusions are reached will continue to matter even as technology becomes more advanced. The goal should not only be completing tasks faster, but also learning how to use these systems carefully and meaningfully.

As AI becomes more integrated into everyday computing, access to capable devices will shape how comfortably students can engage with these experiences over time. For many young users, especially first-time learners, the experience of technology depends not only on software but also on whether devices are practical, accessible, and easy to use regularly.

The writer is the co-founder of Primebook India